SHOPPER MARKETING PROGRAM

National, Whole Foods Market & Publix

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BACKGROUND

Who is Blue Moon?



FOUNDED IN 1995

- Created in 1995 at the SandLot Brewery in Denver, Colorado
- One of the earliest craft-style beers to achieve national distribution
- Helped bring craft beer to mainstream American consumers



CITRUS FLAVOR



- Brewed with Valencia orange peel and coriander for a bright, refreshing taste
- Known for its smooth, slightly sweet citrus profile
- Often served with an orange slice, creating its iconic orange garnish ritual



BELGIAN STYLE WHEAT ALE

- Inspired by traditional Belgian witbier brewing techniques
- Brewed with wheat rather than relying solely on barley, giving it a lighter and smoother mouthfeel
- Positioned as an approachable alternative to heavier or more bitter beers, making it a popular entry beer

BACKGROUND

Market Background Analysis

What made Blue Moon stand out in 1995 is no longer enough to stand out in 2026



Political

- Potential increases in alcohol taxes or excise duties can impact pricing and consumer demand
- Changes in alcohol distribution and retail regulations can influence how alcoholic beverages are marketed and sold across states

Technological

- Social media accelerates beverage trends and discovery
- Younger consumers are influenced by digital culture and recs
- RTDs and canned cocktails continue to grow through convenience and strong digital visibility

Economic

- Consumers are more selective about discretionary spending
- Premium alcoholic beverages must offer clear value proposition
- Competition for consumer spending extends beyond beer to cocktails, RTDs, and non-alcoholic alternatives

Legal

- Growing public awareness of alcohol's health risks is influencing consumption
- A majority of Americans now believe even moderate drinking may be harmful to health

Sociological

- Younger adults are drinking less alcohol than previous generations
- Health consciousness and moderation trends are on the rise
- Consumers seek beverages that align with their lifestyle & identity

Environmental

- Craft beer category has become highly fragmented & crowded
- RTDs, canned cocktails, and alternative alcoholic beverages are gaining share

OUR PROBLEM TO SOLVE

Many of Blue Moon's core drinkers have moved on to other, less "mainstream" craft brands or have left the craft category altogether



As younger shoppers navigate an increasingly crowded alcohol aisle, Blue Moon is easy to overlook.



For unfamiliar customers, the issue little direct experience with the brand/ limited knowledge of beer /no strong mental shortcut.

According to a March 2025 Consumer Insights report by Statista,
Blue Moon ranks **OUTSIDE THE TOP 10** in awareness within the beer market

The barrier is about choice confidence:
younger shoppers need a stronger cue that Blue Moon is socially credible, occasion-appropriate, and worth bringing.

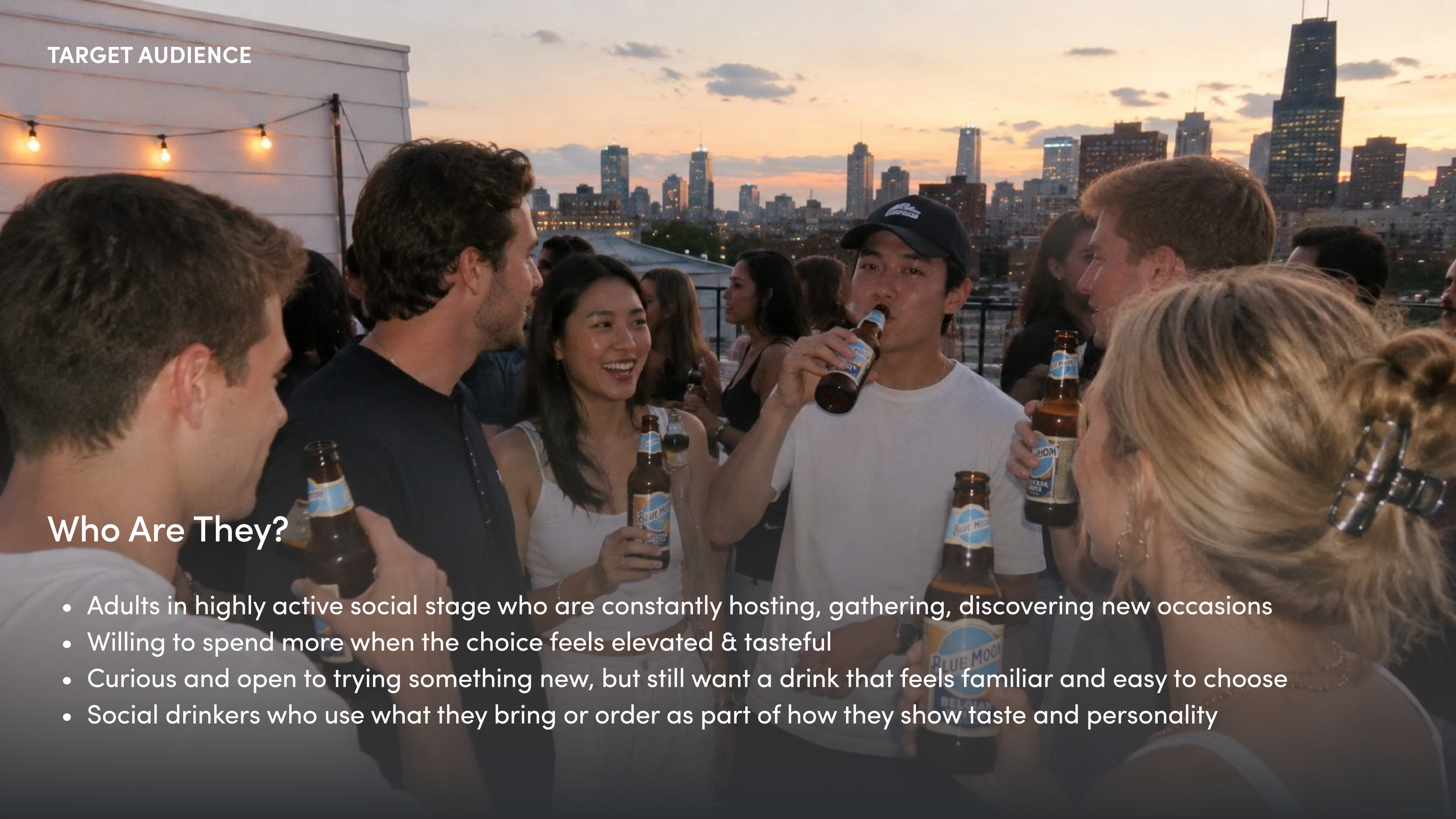
Statista. Brand KPIs for Beer: Blue Moon in the United States. Consumer Insights Report, Mar. 2025, Statista, 2025.

OBJECTIVE

Drive first purchase for younger consumers with little to no experience with Blue Moon.



TARGET AUDIENCE

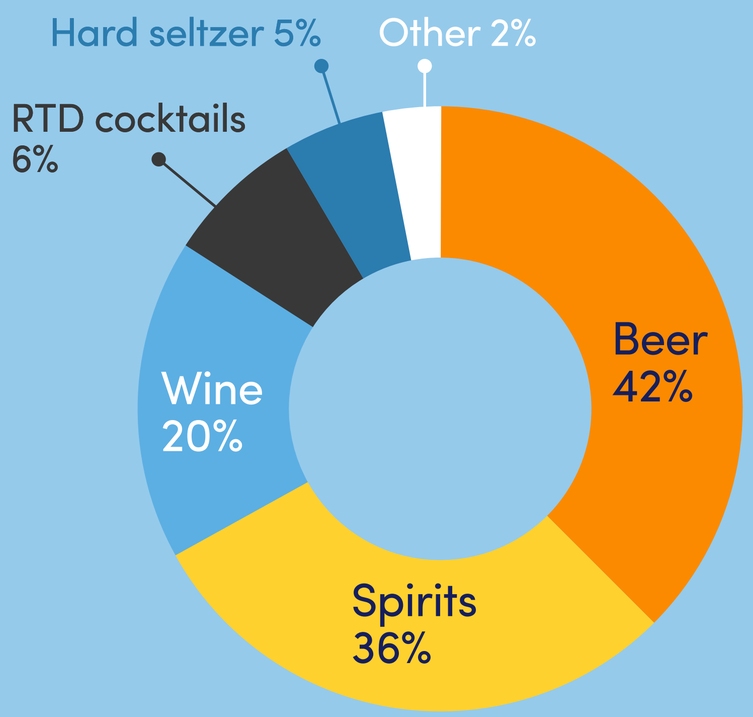


Who Are They?

- Adults in highly active social stage who are constantly hosting, gathering, discovering new occasions
- Willing to spend more when the choice feels elevated & tasteful
- Curious and open to trying something new, but still want a drink that feels familiar and easy to choose
- Social drinkers who use what they bring or order as part of how they show taste and personality

TARGET AUDIENCE

Consumer Beverage Preference Landscape



- Beer dominates at 42%
- The #1 choice among 25–38 year-olds
- Nearly 1 in 2 drinkers in this age group reach for a beer first

https://metricscart.com/insights/beverage-alcohol-trends-in-the-us/



Age 25–38: Strong New Recruits

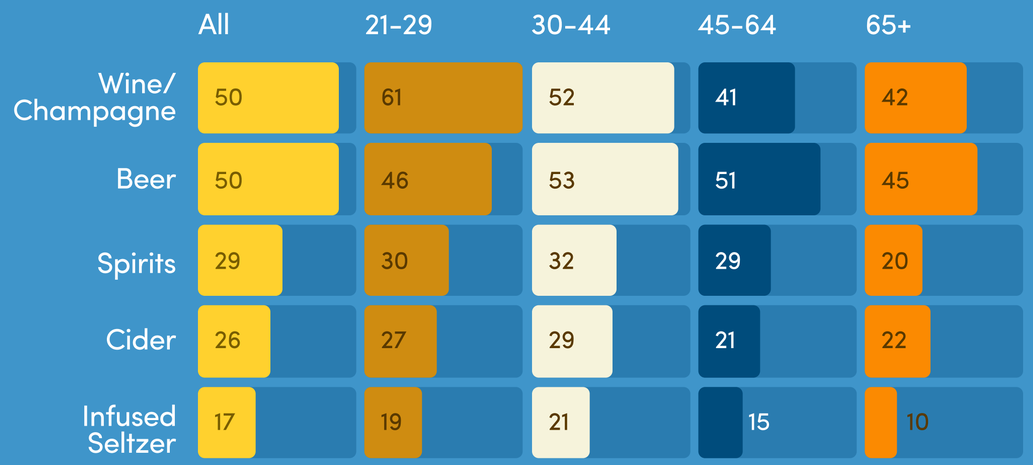
- Limited brand history
- High openness to discovery

Why This Target for Growth?

- Blue Moon's core 39+ drinkers are aging out
- Younger drinkers with limited Blue Moon history give the brand a chance to build fresh relevance instead of relying on nostalgia

Non-alcoholic wine and beer are the most popular choice

Which of the following non-alcoholic beverage alternatives have you consumed in the past 3 months? (% of US adults who have consumed non-alcoholic beverages in the past 3 months)



YouGov

YouGov CategoryView | March 2024 - August 2025

https://yougov.com/en-us/articles/52946-younger-adults-drive-demand-for-non-alcoholic-beverage-alternatives

Young Drinkers Are In the Category & They Drink Socially

1. 60% of 21–34 year olds drink craft beer several times a year (Brewers Association, 2025)
   - Within them, the 21-34 cohort has the highest rate at 45%.

2. 50% of 21–29 year olds drink while hanging out with friends; 35% on dates (YouGov, 2024–2025)

3. Even when going alcohol-free, 61% of 21–29 still choose beer or wine form — the ritual matters, not just the alcohol (YouGov, 2024–2025)

SOCIAL SENTIMENT ANALYSIS & REDDIT LISTENING

Their Drink Choice is A Social Signal & Self-Expression

"What are the best beer to bring to a party when you don't know people's taste?"

173 156

CallingTomServo

Spotted Cow, but I'm from Wisconsin ;)

But for real, it doesn't sound like you are supplying beer for everyone, just that you are bringing some, so just pick something that you have seen others drink.

39 Reply Share ···

Another Popular Reddit Question is...

r/TheGirlSurvivalGuide
bitchnuggets667

What can I order at a bar without sounding like a fool?

"What does your drink say about you?"

21 76

nakedinasnowsuit
yes, please

So like I wonder what being an IPA/gin martini/gin tonic/manhattan drinker means.

OK, I guess I know what it means, I just don't want to admit it.

1 Award Share ···

Broligarchy
Mall Goth Poison Ivy

Inconvenient.

Basically I don't enjoy drinking so I only drink for effect. Lemme sip on a Long Island and be pleasantly tipsy all night.

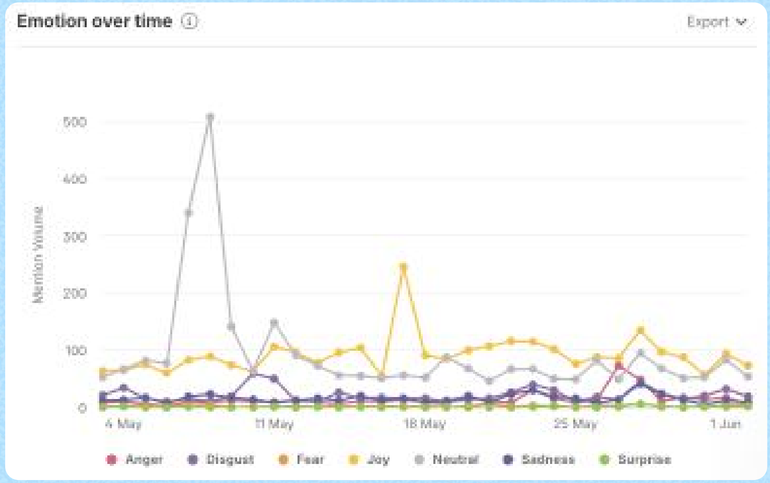
1 Award Share ···

reddit

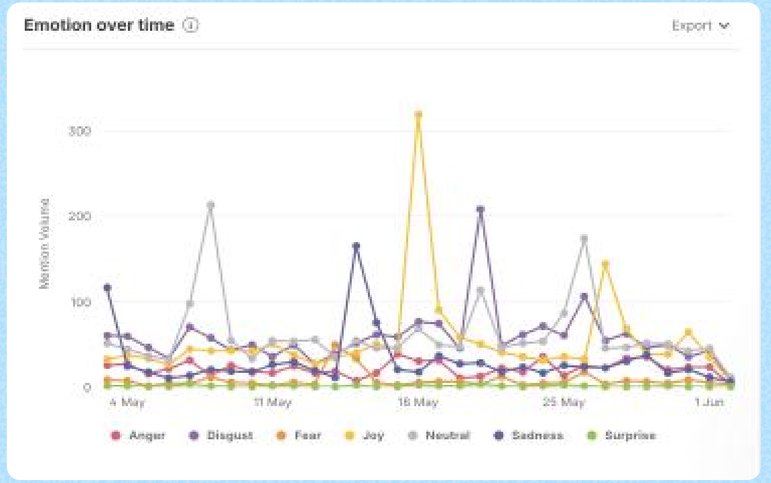
SOCIAL SENTIMENT ANALYSIS & REDDIT LISTENING

Other alcohol categories trigger emotion. Craft beer doesn't.

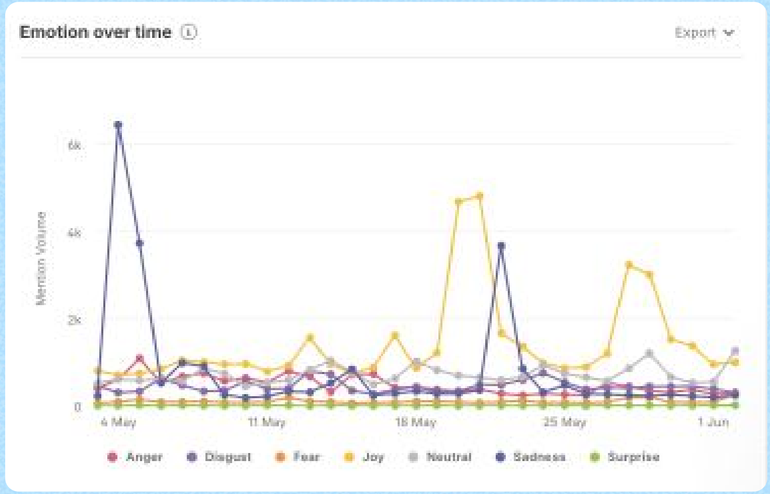
craft beer



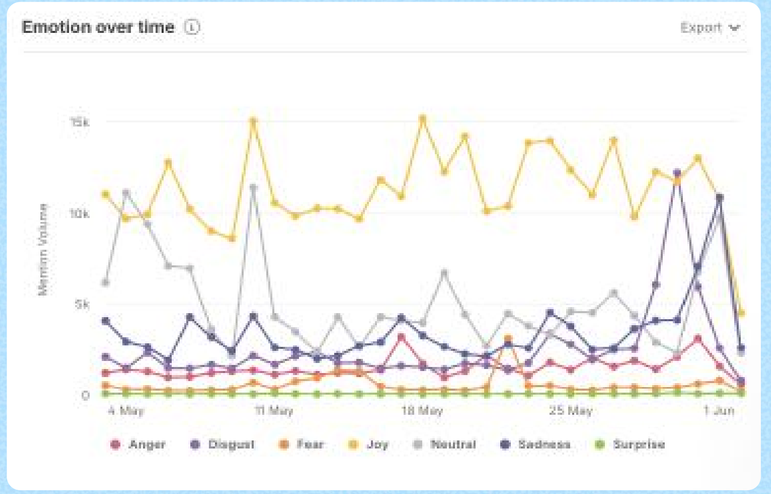
seltzer



cocktail



wine



Brandwatch

SOCIAL SENTIMENT ANALYSIS & REDDIT LISTENING

Key Findings for Insight

Quantitative

Young drinkers are active in craft beer, and every drink decision is a social one

Reddit

They know their drink says something about them. They ask for social proof before they reach

Brandwatch

Craft Beer and Blue Moon barely triggers emotion, it hasn't become a cultural cue yet



Curious Explorers want the drink to feel intentional as a part of self-expression, they are actively scanning for cultural cues that give them that shortcut to credibility.



STRATEGY

Taking Blue Moon from a

BEER AISLE PURCHASE DECISION

into

A CULTURALLY RELEVANT MOMENT

STRATEGY RECAP

FROM

Curious Explorers seeking socially credible drink choices:
"Which beer do I grab?"

TO

Bring Blue Moon any special occasion

BY

Moving Blue Moon from a beer aisle decision into a culturally relevant experience.

BECAUSE

Blue Moon is the social-proof choice



STRATEGY RECAP

The Win Win Win



That single shift unlocks three things for us:

1. Builds social confidence and create that mental shortcut for the young consumer. Blue Moon isn't just a beer. It's the drink that signals you know what goes together and “the vibe”.

2. Move the brand out of the beer set and anchor it to special occasions to create new needs that increase basket size.

3. Increase sales for Blue Moon!!

CREATIVE PLATFORM IDEA



CREATIVE PLATFORM IDEA

Blue Moon shows up as the friend who always knows. Ask Blue Moon.

This idea gives Blue Moon a clear social role in the shopping journey.

Every occasion comes with a social question:

1. What do I bring?
2. Will this feel right?
3. How do I show up like I just knew?



- This idea positions Blue Moon as a social shortcut for younger shoppers who want to make a good choice
- Blue Moon helps shoppers feel confident that they are bringing something credible, approachable, and socially approved

RETAILER 1



BACKGROUND

- Largest natural and organic grocery retailer in the U.S.
- Premium grocery experience focused on quality, freshness, and discovery
- Integrated with Amazon ecosystem for digital shopping convenience

CORE SHOPPER

- Affluent, health-conscious consumers
- Food enthusiasts who enjoy cooking and entertaining
- Higher spending and larger basket sizes than traditional grocery shoppers

RETAILER EQUITIES

- Premium & trusted food destination
- Discovery-driven shopping
- Fresh prepared foods & specialty offerings
- Digital engagement through Amazon & Whole Foods apps
- Food quality and hosting inspiration is center of the experience

RETAILER 2

BACKGROUND

- Largest employee-owned grocery chain in the United States
- Strong regional presence in Southeastern and Mid Atlantic states
- Known for customer service and community-focused shopping experience

CORE SHOPPER

- Family-oriented and occasion-driven shoppers
- Loyal customers making frequent grocery trips
- Convenience-focused consumers planning gatherings and events

RETAILER EQUITIES

- Strong customer trust & loyalty
- Community and gathering-oriented brand perception
- Promotional culture driven by BOGO and weekly deals
- Destination for deli, prepared foods, and entertaining essentials
- Omnichannel engagement through the Publix app and digital circular

TACTICAL IDEAS

Project Structure

creative idea

Ask Blue Moon, The friend who always knows what to bring.

national activation

Don’t know what to bring? Ask Blue Moon.

Establish Blue Moon as the socially credible answer when shopper don’t know what to bring.

retailer a

Whole Foods

Blue Moon knows what belongs at the table.

retailer specific activation

What to bring to a good dinner party? Focus food-centric gatherings.

retailer b

Publix

Blue Moon knows what to bring.

retailer specific activation

what are the essentials to make a good party? Focus on community and neighborhood occasions.

TACTICAL IDEAS

National Activation

Social

PR

Digital



Ask Blue Moon,

The friend who always knows what to bring.

Ecomm

Experie ntial

In-Store

- The objective is to move Blue Moon from a beer category purchase into an occasion-based purchase
- The national activation establishes the core communication platform and strategies that both retailers can adapt to their unique shopper occasions



NATIONAL TACTIC 1

“What Should I Bring?” Creator Series

- Partner with lifestyle, food, hosting and social creators, creating plogs and vlogs with bringing Blue Moon to their gatherings
- Each piece of content ends with: “**Ask Blue Moon**”

Content revolves around common social situations like last-minute BBQ, rooftop gathering, friendsgiving, taco night, tailgate

Purpose

- Build social proof
- Introduce Blue Moon as the default answer

NATIONAL TACTIC 2

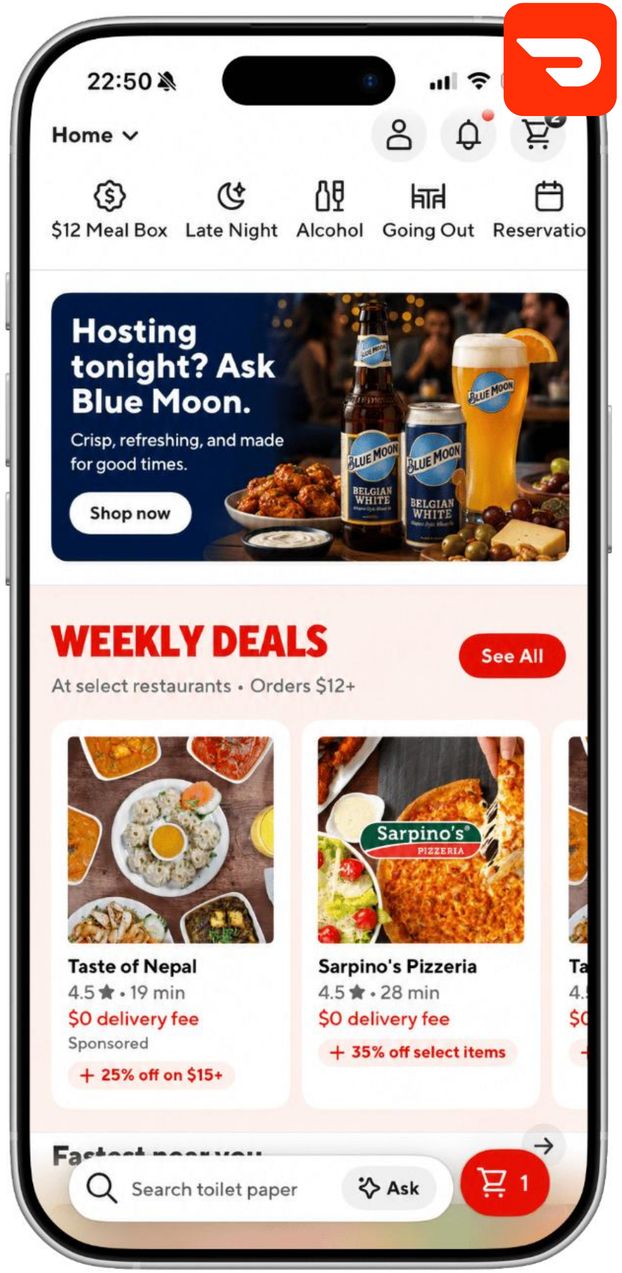
Hosting tonight? Ask Blue Moon.

Retail Media Program

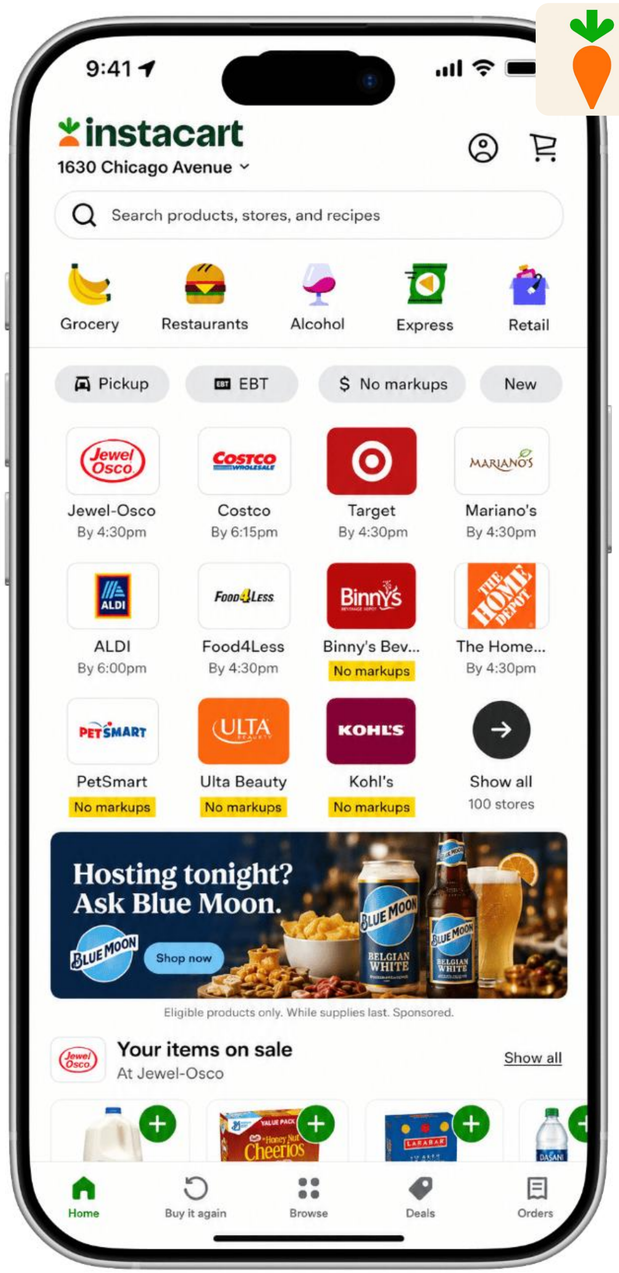
Activate targeted retail digital media to intercept shoppers at the precise moment they are deciding what to bring to an upcoming occasion.

Purpose

- Reach at the exact moment they are planning an occasion
- Position Blue Moon as a natural addition to the basket



BlueMoon Banner on DoorDash



BlueMoon Banner on instacart

Message

Hosting tonight?
Ask Blue Moon.

NATIONAL TACTIC 3

“Don’t Know What To Bring?”

Endcap Toolkit

National POS package displayed across participating retailers

Cross-merchandise with potential items Blue Moon could be paired with when bringing to different occasions

Header
DON’T KNOW WHAT TO BRING? ASK BLUE MOON.

Purpose

- Make Blue Moon the default answer for social occasions
- Increase visibility beyond the beer aisle
- Drive cross-category basket growth



NATIONAL TACTIC 4

#AskBlueMoon

Social Proof UGC Campaign

Idea

Invite consumers to post photos or short videos of Blue Moon at their social occasions using #AskBlueMoon

- The times Blue Moon helped them show up with the right drink for the occasion

Strategic Value

This tactic solves the fear of wrong choice

- Reinforce Blue Moon as the socially approved choice
- Generate authentic earned content
- Create peer-to-peer recommendation loops



#AskBlueMoon on TikTok



#AskBlueMoon on X

RETAILER 1 ACTIVATION

Retailer Role

Whole Foods allows Blue Moon to own premium hosting occasions and food-centric gatherings.





Blue Moon knows what to bring to a good dinner party.

WHOLE FOODS SHOPPER JOURNEY

pre-shop → shop → post-shop



Amazon/Whole Foods Pre-Shop Occasion Trigger

MESSAGE
Hosting tonight?
Ask Blue Moon.

OBJECTIVE
Build consideration before store entry.

Ask Blue Moon BBQ Pairing Station



MESSAGE
Going to a cookout and don't know what to bring?
Ask Blue Moon.

OBJECTIVE
Create no cost experience at proof that Blue Moon is the right choice.



Orange Companion Display

MESSAGE
Good friends bring the orange too.

OBJECTIVE
Reinforce a distinctive Blue Moon ritual.



Occasion Guide QR Follow-Up

MESSAGE
Glad you brought Blue Moon.

OBJECTIVE
Reinforce it as the go-to choice for future social occasions.



RETAILER 2 ACTIVATION

What are the essentials to make a good party?

Retailer Role

Publix allows Blue Moon to own community gatherings, tailgates and game-day occasions.





The activation focuses on social gatherings where shoppers are bringing something to contribute.

PUBLIX SHOPPER JOURNEY

pre-shop → shop → post-shop



Publix Digital Circular & Retail Media

MESSAGE
Game day this weekend?
Ask Blue Moon.

OBJECTIVE
Create occasion based consideration.







In-Aisle Product Glorifier

MESSAGE

- Need a host-approved choice? Ask Blue Moon.
- _____ with Blue Moon.
- Grab a card, pick up at cashier.

OBJECTIVE
Extend visibility beyond the beer aisle.

Digital Receipt Follow-Up
Publix app & Loyalty Communications

MESSAGE
Thanks for bringing Blue Moon.
Share your #AskBlueMoon

OBJECTIVE
Drive advocacy and social proof.



RETAILER SHOPPER JOURNEY

Win-Win-Win

Shoppers

CONFIDENCE

- Solves the “What should I bring?” uncertainty
- Makes Blue Moon feel like an easy, socially right choice
  - Whole Foods adds premium food-pairing inspiration
  - Publix adds simple party and game-day solutions

Retailer

BASKET OWNERSHIP

- Turns Blue Moon into a cross-category basket builder.
  - Whole Foods builds premium hosting baskets
  - Publix builds party, deli, snack, and game-day baskets

Blue Moon

OCCASION OWNERSHIP

- Moves Blue Moon beyond the beer aisle
- Builds association with hosting, meals, and social gatherings
- Drives first purchase by making Blue Moon the answer to the occasion

Budget

Blue Moon Shopper Journey Activation Plan Budget Allocation	
Tactic	*Budget ($)*
National Activation Cost	
Creator Funds (creator series & social activation)	30,000
Retail Media	20,000
Placement Fee	20,000
Endcap Toolkit	10,000
Total	**80,000**
Whole Foods Activation Cost	
Media Occasion Trigger (pre-shop)	15,000
Ask Blue Moon BBQ Pairing Station (shop)	25,000
Orange Companion Display (shop)	20,000
Placement Fee (shop)	5,000
Occasion Guide QR Follow-up (post-shop)	5,000
Total	**70,000**
Publix Activation Cost	
Publix Digital Circular & Retail Media (pre-shop)	15,000
In-Aisle Product Glorifier (shop)	10,000
Placement Fee (shop)	10,000
Digital Receipt Follow-Up (post-shop)	5,000
Total	**40,000**
National Activation Cost	80,000
Whole Foods Activation Cost	70,000
Publix Activation Cost	40,000
Post Campaign Performance Data	10,000
Total Budget Allocation	**200,000**

Assuming that retailers share data of the campaign and we perform our measurement with in-house marketing analyst.

MEASUREMENT PLAN



Primary Objective
Increase household penetration and drive first-time purchase among 25–38 year old Curious Explorers

Success will be evaluated using **three levels of measurement**, aligning measurement with the priorities of Blue Moon, retail partners, and the shopper:

1. **PROGRAM PERFORMANCE** → *Did the campaign work?*
2. **BUSINESS IMPACT** → *Did Blue Moon generates trail, new buyers, and sales?*
3. **RETAILER IMPACT** → *Did retailers (Whole Foods & Publix) benefit?*



EVALUATING SUCCESS

Measurement Plan



LEVEL 1: PROGRAM PERFORMANCE

Did the program enter the shopper's consideration set before purchase?

Social Reach & Impressions

Measures # of people exposed to the message

Method

Instagram & TikTok dashboards

CTR

Indicates whether the message generated interest

Method

Creator content & retail media reporting

Add-to-Cart Rate

Purchase intent, strongest signal that Blue Moon entered consideration

Method

Amazon Ads, Instacart and Publix Digital

Engagement Rate

Measures audience interaction with the program message

Method

Likes, comments, shares, saves

These KPIs indicate awareness and consideration, but do not directly measure purchase behavior

EVALUATING SUCCESS

Measurement Plan



LEVEL 2: BUSINESS IMPACT

Did the program generate trial, new buyers, and sales?

$ ROMO | Measures Acquisition Efficiency
Total program cost ÷ new households acquired

New household penetration

Measures whether Blue Moon gained new buyers

Method

Retailer shopper card data

First-time buyer rate

Tracks % of buyers who were first-time Blue Moon purchasers

Method

Loyalty card analysis

Repeat purchase rate

Measures retention and loyalty after trial

Method

Loyalty card data, 12-week post-program window

In-store sales lift

Validates that new buyer acquisition translated into commercial growth

Method

Store-level test vs. control, year-over-year analysis, syndicated sales data

***Limitations**: Results may be influenced by external factors such as competitive promotions or seasonality; As with in-program loyalty tracking, cash purchasers and non-cardholders are excluded from this analysis.*

EVALUATING SUCCESS

Measurement Plan



LEVEL 3: RETAILER IMPACT

Did retailers (Whole Foods & Publix) benefit from supporting the program?

RORR

Measures the strength of retailer partnership outcomes

Method: Post-program business review with buyer teams

Basket attachment rate

Measures retailer value creation through increased basket value

Method: Beer and occasion food basket analysis

Category sales growth

Demonstrates the program contribution to overall beer category growth

Method: POS data

New-to-category buyers

Measures shopper acquisition into the beer category

Method: Retailer loyalty data

Notes: *Retailer-level metrics rely on internal POS and loyalty data. Given the program's $10K measurement budget, access to all person-level shopper data may be limited; however, retailer partners can evaluate these outcomes internally and incorporate findings into post-program business reviews.*



any questions?

ASK BLUE MOON

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Link to Blue Moon Presentation

https://www.figma.com/deck/cBXI2HvKgNZoMz4dMRFLjj/Blue-Moon-Final?node-id=0-1&t=KlO5nqpCn1LnwF4j-1

Video and GIF are embedded so PDF won’t work